

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Season 1 Episode Guide

Document 11 · Locked Canon · Episodes #0001–#0180

Monday, January 3, 2005 – Friday, September 16, 2005 · 180 new episodes · Weekdays

Every episode's in-universe story day matches its airdate unless the synopsis says otherwise. Ages follow Document 02 and `tools/ages.py`.

JANUARY 2005

Week of January 3

- **#0001 · Mon., Jan. 3 — SERIES PREMIERE.** At dawn, Smilley Tower opens directly across Peachtree Road from Donohue Tower while Victor watches from the 88th floor. Esther Smilley arrives in Atlanta with her twins, Chief Elxa Jackson holds her first press conference, and Marc-Anthony reads to sick kids at Egleston between calls about BSI's tsunami relief in Sri Lanka. *Cliffhanger:* A body turns up in Piedmont Park clutching a black Onyx Coin, and Sovereign never ordered it.
- **#0002 · Tue., Jan. 4** — Jasmine is sworn in for her 10th term in Washington. Martin takes a late-night call from "overseas" (we hear only his side). Amond and Harmony's silent Lyric handoff in the Phipps Plaza deck turns into a screaming match. Marc gathers The Seven: "Somebody's using our coin."
- **#0003 · Wed., Jan. 5 — Marc's 23rd birthday** at Belle Rive. Grace sings "Crown Me" and Simone gives him Alexander's pocket watch. Esther, curious about her new neighbors' invitation, gets as far as the Crown Gate, sees Marc's face on the guardhouse monitor, and orders her driver to turn around.
- **#0004 · Thu., Jan. 6** — Harmony marches into new DA Arianna Cummings' office and begs her to reopen her missing brother Darnell's case. Arianna, shaking, promises she will. Grace and Mallory pitch Grace & Glory to Simone, who agrees to hand over her 1935 formulas on one condition: "Beat the Smilleys."
- **#0005 · Fri., Jan. 7** — A second Onyx Coin victim, a Southside loan shark, is found. Elxa launches the APD Blackwater Task Force under Jeremy, and FBI Special Agent Kate Doyle crashes the scene claiming jurisdiction. *Cliffhanger:* Arianna calls Marc, hysterical: "She asked ME to find him, Marc."

Week of January 10

- **#0006 · Mon., Jan. 10** — Marc promises Arianna he'll handle it. Amond, who doesn't know the truth, offers Harmony BSI's help finding Dee, and she slaps him for thinking money fixes everything. Natasha smells an unfamiliar perfume on Robert's collar: Smile, by Vivienne Smilley.
- **#0007 · Tue., Jan. 11** — At her first Smilley Atlanta board meeting, Esther names her secret weapon: Harmony will broker every Smilley land deal in Atlanta. Overnight, Harmony becomes the most envied agent in Buckhead. Luke and Delphine are livid.
- **#0008 · Wed., Jan. 12** — At Velvet, Mallory meets a charming DJ who calls himself only "Q," and they talk until 3 a.m. Across town, Martin meets Desmond Smilley in the Ritz-Carlton Buckhead bar: "It seems we have the same problem."
- **#0009 · Thu., Jan. 13** — Gloria Baker serves Harmony with a grandparent-visitation petition. Harmony blames Amond, who knew nothing about it. Elxa's first command-staff meeting leaks to the press within the hour, courtesy of Deputy Chief Hughes.
- **#0010 · Fri., Jan. 14** — The Seven trace the counterfeit Onyx Coins to a private mint in Johannesburg. Jeremy finds security footage from Piedmont Park showing a tall white man. *Cliffhanger*: Martin slides Cyrus Knox a thick envelope: "Again. Bigger."

Week of January 17

- **#0011 · Mon., Jan. 17** — **MLK Day** at Greater Crest Tabernacle: Bishop Lyons honors Joan's civil-rights legacy. Esther slips out of the back pew just as Marc walks in late. He catches the scent of jasmine, turns, and sees only a closing door.
- **#0012 · Tue., Jan. 18** — Victor learns the mayor will open bids on the \$4 billion Auburn Avenue Revival, the street where Alexander started, and that the Smilleys are bidding. Natasha: "Over my dead body." Vivienne, across town: "That can be arranged."
- **#0013 · Wed., Jan. 19** — Mallory discovers "Q" is Quentin Smilley and storms out of the Olson Estate. He follows her to the parking deck with one sunflower and an apology. Peter opens an anonymous envelope holding a 2001 photo of a masked patient on an operating table.
- **Thu., Jan. 20** — *No new episode: network coverage of the Presidential Inauguration.*
- **#0014 · Fri., Jan. 21** — Elxa and Doyle clash in front of the cameras. Marc offers APD free BSI forensics, and Elxa refuses on live TV: "I don't need my little brother's company." *Cliffhanger*: The third Onyx victim is Detective Terrence Oakes, a clean cop, which breaks Blackwater's Ninth Law.

Week of January 24

- **#0015 · Mon., Jan. 24** — Odessa Smilley's **85th birthday** dinner at Ravenhurst: "To Atlanta. May Simone live long enough to watch." At Grady, Oakes survives surgery. Sovereign tells The Seven

the hunt for the copycat is now personal.

- **#0016 · Tue., Jan. 25** — Luke storms into Esther's office over the Harmony deals. Noelle overhears every word and sells the gossip to Delphine for a seat at her next luncheon. CrestWatch posts it by midnight.
- **#0017 · Wed., Jan. 26** — Amond and Harmony meet court evaluator Dr. Miriam Kessler, who writes that Lyric's parents "clearly despise each other." Amond proposes a truce. Harmony proposes he jump off the Jackson Street bridge.
- **#0018 · Thu., Jan. 27** — Victoria gives Nanny Bea the slip at Lenox Square. Marc finds the tiny escape artist in FAO Schwarz and makes her laugh until Bea arrives, and neither knows who the other is. Across the atrium, Esther sees Marc holding her daughter and can't breathe.
- **#0019 · Fri., Jan. 28** — Jeremy traces the counterfeit coins to a crate at the Port of Savannah owned by a Donohue Shipping subsidiary, which puts the family in the frame. *Cliffhanger*: Elxa has to decide whether to subpoena her own grandfather.

Week of January 31 — February Sweeps

- **#0020 · Mon., Jan. 31** — Elxa subpoenas Donohue Shipping. Victor receives her at Donohue Tower: "You'll get your records, Chief. And you'll remember who taught you to read." That night Camille Rhodes, in Robert's office, dabs on Smile perfume.

FEBRUARY 2005

- **#0021 · Tue., Feb. 1** — Martin smoothly "cooperates" with APD and steers Jeremy toward Bullock & Associates as the crate's legal agent. Esther tells Harmony it frightened her to see Marc-Anthony Bullock hold Victoria. Harmony assumes it's just the feud.
- **#0022 · Wed., Feb. 2** — Grace brings her co-star boyfriend, Derrick Vance, to Belle Rive for the first time. Marc likes him, and Nana Ruby doesn't. Gideon Ashe loses \$30 million in one night at an underground Blackwater Parlor.
- **#0023 · Thu., Feb. 3** — **FEBRUARY SWEEPS BEGIN.** The fourth Onyx victim is a West End barber who paid for Blackwater protection. On the shop's wall, spray-painted in red: SOVEREIGN = BULLOCK. APD brings Robert Bullock in for questioning.
- **#0024 · Fri., Feb. 4** — Jeremy grills Robert for six hours while Elxa watches through the glass. Robert just smiles. Natasha arrives with three lawyers and a subpoena for Jeremy's personnel file. *Cliffhanger*: In the parking lot, Martin phones overseas: "It's working."

Week of February 7 — February Sweeps

- **#0025 · Mon., Feb. 7** — Simone calls an emergency Crown Council and orders the family to close ranks. Marc quietly realizes that someone inside the family is pointing the law at his father.
- **#0026 · Tue., Feb. 8** — Celeste Vaughn's WBKG exclusive asks, "Is Atlanta's Top Defense Lawyer Sovereign?" Marc confronts her, she chooses the story over him, and their relationship ends on the Pavilion steps.
- **#0027 · Wed., Feb. 9** — Arianna refuses to charge Robert without evidence, and Doyle is furious. Privately, Arianna warns Marc the pressure is coming from Martin's circle. Esther reads three years of Harmony's "Find Dee" archive and quietly hires private investigators.
- **#0028 · Thu., Feb. 10** — Ghost links the Johannesburg mint to a mercenary named Cyrus Knox. Mallory and Quentin's secret rooftop dinner at the Four Seasons ends in an almost-kiss and a security guard.
- **#0029 · Fri., Feb. 11** — Knox spots BSI surveillance and goes to ground. *Cliffhanger*: Harmony comes home to her front door kicked in, Lyric's nursery torn apart, and an Onyx Coin on the crib.

Week of February 14 — February Sweeps

- **#0030 · Mon., Feb. 14** — **Valentine's Day**. Lyric was safe at Gloria's, but a terrified Harmony accepts Amond's offer to move into his Buckhead penthouse. Elxa and Jeremy's anniversary dinner is interrupted by a call, and Mallory receives 99 roses from "Q."
- **#0031 · Tue., Feb. 15** — Amond tells Marc he's done with limits: "They came to my daughter's crib." Marc: "Then there are no lines." The Seven vote unanimously to hunt Knox.
- **#0032 · Wed., Feb. 16** — Natasha follows Robert to a Midtown hotel and watches Camille walk into his suite. She says nothing. By morning, she owns the hotel.
- **#0033 · Thu., Feb. 17** — Marc's and Esther's lawyers face off in bid talks at City Hall. The two principals sit in adjoining rooms separated by one wall, each listening. Harmony and Amond's first night under one roof ends in a fight over bedtime stories.
- **#0034 · Fri., Feb. 18** — Roman Gaines corners Knox's triggerman in a Stewart Avenue motel: Dwayne Pruitt, son of the crooked cop who covered for Harlow in 2000. *Cliffhanger*: Pruitt escapes, but not before he sees Amond's face.

Week of February 21 — February Sweeps

- **#0035 · Mon., Feb. 21** — **SPECIAL FLASHBACK EPISODE: "New Year's, 2002."** The audience learns the truth: 19-year-old Arianna hit and killed Darnell Divine on a dark road, and Marc made it

all disappear before sunrise. In the present, Arianna watches Harmony's candlelight vigil from her car.

- **#0036 · Tue., Feb. 22** — Pruitt describes the man who hunted him, and Knox tells Martin it was Amond Baker. Martin smiles: "Marc's best friend." At a photo shoot, Grace hides a purple bruise on her wrist under long sleeves.
- **#0037 · Wed., Feb. 23** — Jeremy connects Dwayne Pruitt to the buried 2000 Harlow case and pulls the file. The closing signature is his father's.
- **#0038 · Thu., Feb. 24 — THE SOVEREIGN BROADCAST.** During Celeste's live 6 p.m. newscast, a distorted voice hijacks WBKG's signal: "The Onyx killer is not Blackwater. Chief Jackson, in seven days I will deliver him to your door." Atlanta loses its mind.
- **#0039 · Fri., Feb. 25** — The FBI accuses APD of a leak, and Hughes suggests aloud that the Chief knows Sovereign personally. *Cliffhanger:* Martin realizes the countdown will expose Knox and orders Pruitt killed first.

Week of February 28 — February Sweeps

- **#0040 · Mon., Feb. 28** — Day 5 of the countdown. Harmony hires BSI to find her brother, and Marc personally accepts the case with a smile that hides a scream.
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MARCH 2005

- **#0041 · Tue., Mar. 1** — Knox reaches Pruitt first, but Roman is already waiting. A chase down the Downtown Connector ends with Knox escaping and Pruitt in the Syndicate's hands.
- **#0042 · Wed., Mar. 2 — FEBRUARY SWEEPS FINALE.** Day 7, dawn: Dwayne Pruitt is found bound on the steps of APD headquarters at City Hall East with an Onyx Coin in his mouth and a signed confession. Elxa stands over him as cameras flash. *Cliffhanger:* At City Hall, Marc walks into the bid hearing, and the woman at the Smilley table turns around. Esther.
- **#0043 · Thu., Mar. 3 — THE MEETING.** Marc and Esther's first face-to-face is 20 white-hot minutes of war over Auburn Avenue that leaves both of them flustered and the whole room staring. He catches jasmine again. "Have we met?" "Never."
- **#0044 · Fri., Mar. 4** — Pruitt's confession names only "a white man with an accent," so Martin is safe for now. Marc can't stop thinking about Esther. At home, Esther unlocks a box and holds the gold mask she has hidden for three and a half years.

Week of March 7

- **#0045 • Mon., Mar. 7** — The rivalry turns into a door-to-door race for Auburn Avenue parcels, and both heirs show up at the same widow's porch at 7 a.m. Mallory learns Vivienne's lab has asked a supplier for Grace & Glory's exact ingredients.
- **#0046 • Tue., Mar. 8** — Sebastian Kingsley arrives from London and announces the wedding date to the *Sentinel*: Friday, September 16, at Ravenhurst. Marc reads it and pretends not to care. Grace skips Sunday dinner, and Nana Ruby knows why.
- **#0047 • Wed., Mar. 9** — Jeremy confronts his father about the Harlow file. Harold admits he closed it on "orders from above." Camille confesses to Robert that the FBI has approached her. She says she told them nothing.
- **#0048 • Thu., Mar. 10** — Simone announces a Centennial Founders' Ball for Alexander's 100th birthday and invites Odessa Smiley. The family is horrified. Victor: "Mother, why?" Simone: "Because I want to watch her face."
- **#0049 • Fri., Mar. 11** — Chaos before the ball: Harmony and Amond are forced to be each other's dates, Mallory sneaks Quentin in as a waiter, and Esther decides to go. *Cliffhanger*: Odessa's limousine glides through the Crown Gate, the first Smiley ever admitted to Belmont Crest.

Week of March 14

- **#0050 • Mon., Mar. 14** — **THE CENTENNIAL BALL** (Alexander's 100th birthday). Simone and Odessa have their legendary face-off in the Simone Ballroom. Marc asks Esther to dance to settle a bet, and they don't let go for three songs. *Cliffhanger*: In the Dowager House, Simone's jewelry box stands open, and the Savannah Letter is gone.
- **#0051 • Tue., Mar. 15** — Simone orders Marc to find the letter quietly. The suspects are Odessa, Vivienne, and every staffer on duty. Mallory and Quentin share their first kiss in the Lake Simone gazebo.
- **#0052 • Wed., Mar. 16** — Tipsy after the ball, Harmony and Amond sleep together and wake up furious with themselves. Grace arrives at brunch in sunglasses and claims it's allergies.
- **#0053 • Thu., Mar. 17** — Martin tells Desmond the ball proved one thing: "Marc is in love with your niece. That's a weapon." At Ravenhurst, Esther breaks a wineglass remembering the dance.
- **#0054 • Fri., Mar. 18** — Winston cross-checks BSI gate logs and finds that Noelle Smiley spent six unexplained minutes alone in the Dowager House wing. *Cliffhanger*: In her car, Noelle opens a yellowed 1952 envelope and gasps.

Week of March 21

- **#0055 · Mon., Mar. 21** — Noelle sells the letter to Odessa for a promised seat on the Smilley board. Odessa pays in cash and warns her never to speak of it again.
- **#0056 · Tue., Mar. 22** — Elxa and Jeremy agree to quietly reopen the Harlow case. In the file is Grace's July 2000 hospital admission record.
- **#0057 · Wed., Mar. 23** — At **Jasmine's 45th birthday** luncheon, party leaders urge her to run for Governor in 2006, and Martin sees his own path to power. Peter receives a second photo. This one shows him, in surgical scrubs, in 2001.
- **#0058 · Thu., Mar. 24** — Elxa asks Grace about the night of July 15, 2000. Grace lies flawlessly, then calls Marc from the parking lot, sobbing. He realizes the Harlow case is breathing again.
- **#0059 · Fri., Mar. 25** — Alone at Ravenhurst, Odessa reads the Savannah Letter: Cornelius was bluffing. She laughs, then weeps. *Cliffhanger*: She locks the letter in her safe and calls the Dowager House: "Simone. We should have tea."

Week of March 28

- **#0060 · Mon., Mar. 28** — **Easter Monday**. At yesterday's service, Delphine photographed Mallory and Quentin holding hands. Harmony takes a pregnancy test, and it's negative. She cries, and can't tell whether it's relief.
- **#0061 · Tue., Mar. 29** — Delphine gives the photo to Desmond, who orders his son to keep dating the Olson girl and "bring me her brand." Quentin refuses, and Desmond freezes his accounts.
- **#0062 · Wed., Mar. 30** — Vivienne unveils "Odessa Glow," a skincare line eerily identical to Grace & Glory's formula. Mallory is devastated, and Grace blames "your Smilley boy."
- **#0063 · Thu., Mar. 31** — At the Swan Coach House, the two queens trade 50 years of insults over tea. Odessa lets slip that she has "read something you should have shown me in 1952."

APRIL 2005

- **#0064 · Fri., Apr. 1** — **April Fools' Day**. Marc runs a prank war at BSI Tower, and Brielle wins. Esther's investigators deliver a report: Darnell Divine's last known location was Northside Drive at 2:15 a.m. on January 1, 2002, three miles from a party. *Cliffhanger*: Esther circles one name on the guest list. Arianna Cummings.

Week of April 4

- **#0065 · Mon., Apr. 4** — Natasha confronts Robert about Camille in the lobby of the hotel she bought. Then she hires Camille as General Counsel of Donohue Hospitality Group at triple salary, stealing Robert's best lawyer and keeping her enemy close.
- **#0066 · Tue., Apr. 5** — Robert is stunned. Doyle smells an opportunity: an informant who could reach both DHG and Robert's bed. Amond notices that BSI's search for Dee has mysteriously stalled.
- **#0067 · Wed., Apr. 6** — Esther invites Arianna to lunch and, all smiles, mentions Northside Drive. Arianna walks out and throws up in the alley.
- **#0068 · Thu., Apr. 7** — Arianna warns Marc that Esther knows something. Marc goes to Ravenhurst for the first time, and they face off at midnight in Esther's library. "What do you want?" "Auburn Avenue."
- **#0069 · Fri., Apr. 8** — Marc refuses to be blackmailed, and Esther refuses to back down. *Cliffhanger*: As he leaves, Victoria pads down the staircase in pajamas, beams, and says, "Hi, Marc!" Esther goes white.

Week of April 11

- **#0070 · Mon., Apr. 11** — Marc is charmed by Victoria and puzzled by Esther's terror. Nanny Bea notices the little girl laughs exactly like the man at the door.
- **#0071 · Tue., Apr. 12** — At **Grace's 21st birthday** at Sanctuary, Derrick grabs her arm hard in front of Mallory. Grace begs her cousin not to tell anyone.
- **#0072 · Wed., Apr. 13** — Hughes engineers a City Council no-confidence hearing on the Chief. Elxa testifies brilliantly. Then Councilman Hardaway waves a letter suggesting Victor lobbied the mayor. Elxa: "That is a lie."
- **#0073 · Thu., Apr. 14** — Jeremy discovers the letter is real. Mayor Whitaker privately admits that Victor and Robert "made calls." Jeremy decides not to tell his wife.
- **#0074 · Fri., Apr. 15** — Peter meets his blackmailer in the Olson surgical suite: a strikingly handsome man calling himself Julian Cross, wearing the face Peter built. *Cliffhanger*: "Doctor, you gave me a new life. Now I want my old one back."

Week of April 18

- **#0075 · Mon., Apr. 18** — In flashback, Peter remembers April 2001: \$5 million in cash, a masked man with a destroyed face, and a Cancún clinic with no names. In the present, Julian Cross tells him who he really is: Vaughn "Silk" Harlow.

- **#0076 · Tue., Apr. 19** — Harlow demands that Peter get him into Belmont Crest society. Peter refuses, and Harlow slides over a photo of Mallory leaving Spelman. At Joan's birthday brunch, Peter can't swallow.
- **#0077 · Wed., Apr. 20** — **Lyric's 3rd birthday** at the Bakers'. Marc is her godfather, and this time Harmony won't let Esther make excuses. The twins and Lyric play princesses with "Uncle Marc" as the dragon, while Esther watches with her heart breaking.
- **#0078 · Thu., Apr. 21** — Gloria overhears Harmony and Amond fighting about the night after the ball. Then 15-year-old Kiara announces to the whole party: "Aunt Esther's twins have Uncle Marc's dimples!" The room goes silent.
- **#0079 · Fri., Apr. 22** — Esther laughs it off. Marc laughs, and so does Harmony. Amond doesn't. *Cliffhanger*: Tidying Esther's dressing room, Nanny Bea finds a gold mask in a locked box, along with a 2001 *Black Enterprise* cover with Marc's face circled.

Week of April 25 — May Sweeps

- **#0080 · Mon., Apr. 25** — Bea confronts no one. She simply tells Esther: "I raise them. I'll protect them from everyone." Esther understands that Bea knows.
- **#0081 · Tue., Apr. 26** — The Auburn Avenue finalists are announced: DGH and Smiley. In a parked car, Esther hands Councilman Hardaway an envelope.
- **#0082 · Wed., Apr. 27** — As Julian Cross, Harlow charms Buckhead society and buys the absent Alvin's partners out of Velvet: "Alvin's in Miami. He'll love me." In the April heat, Grace wears a scarf.
- **#0083 · Thu., Apr. 28** — **MAY SWEEPS BEGIN.** At a movie-premiere afterparty, Derrick shoves Grace down a marble staircase. Paparazzo Vince Maretti captures the aftermath, and Marc sees the photo.
- **#0084 · Fri., Apr. 29** — **THE CRASH-OUT.** Outside Sanctuary, Marc drives a BSI armored truck into Derrick's empty Bentley and flips it onto its roof in the middle of Peachtree Road. Then he drags Derrick into the street by his collar. *Cliffhanger*: Sirens. Elxa steps out of her car: "Marc-Anthony Bullock, you're under arrest."

MAY 2005

Week of May 2 — May Sweeps

- **#0085 · Mon., May 2** — Marc's mugshot is on every front page, and Martin files a formal Disgrace Clause petition with the Crown Council. From her hospital bed, with her wrist in a cast, Grace tells the police the truth about Derrick.
- **#0086 · Tue., May 3** — Arianna recuses herself and a special prosecutor takes Marc's case. Robert defends his son, and Joan sits behind him in the courtroom for the first time since she retired.
- **#0087 · Wed., May 4** — At the Magnolia Cotillion, Kiara Baker is presented. Quentin crashes to dance with Mallory in front of both families, and Delphine and Natasha nearly come to blows over a centerpiece.
- **#0088 · Thu., May 5** — Derrick withdraws his complaint after a visit from men he won't describe. Grace tells her story in an exclusive to Celeste on WBKG. Marc thanks Celeste, and old sparks flicker.
- **#0089 · Fri., May 6** — The special prosecutor reduces the charge to a misdemeanor, so Martin's petition now needs a two-thirds Council vote. *Cliffhanger:* Simone schedules the vote for Monday morning.

Week of May 9 — May Sweeps

- **#0090 · Mon., May 9 — THE PRODIGAL PRINCE.** As the Crown Council meets to vote on Martin's petition, a helicopter lands on the Summit helipad. **Alvin Donohue** is home from Miami, sunburned, charming, and ready to vote. He votes no, and the petition fails 6–1–1. The lone "yes" is Theodore's written proxy from Monaco.
- **#0091 · Tue., May 10 — The twins' 3rd birthday** at Ravenhurst. Victoria vanishes mid-party, crosses the Nancy Creek ravine, and knocks on the door of the Bullock Pavilion. Marc carries her home.
- **#0092 · Wed., May 11** — At the Ravenhurst gate, in the rain, Esther thanks Marc. Lucius orders him off Smilley land, and Marc bows to him. Then he turns to Esther: "She's got my laugh, you know. Weird." Esther nearly faints.
- **#0093 · Thu., May 12** — At Sunday dinner, Alvin roasts everyone and hugs Marc too long, then slips out to meet his new business partner at Velvet: Julian Cross. Silas Merriweather sends Alvin a funeral wreath with his name on the ribbon.
- **#0094 · Fri., May 13 — Friday the 13th.** Lucius collapses in the middle of a Smilley board meeting. *Cliffhanger:* Luke rushes to his side, and behind him Vivienne and Desmond exchange a look.

Week of May 16 — May Sweeps

- **#0095 · Mon., May 16** — CrestWatch leaks Lucius's Parkinson's diagnosis within the hour. With Esther's succession in question, Luke demands the board name an interim CEO: himself.
- **#0096 · Tue., May 17** — Martin and Desmond plot to put Luke on the throne. Desmond lets slip the family's darkest secret: "Luke is mine."
- **#0097 · Wed., May 18** — Delphine finds Vivienne's 1975 love letters to Desmond. She realizes Luke is Desmond's son and hides the letters to use as a weapon.
- **#0098 · Thu., May 19** — At the final Auburn Avenue presentation, Esther wins 8–7 with Councilman Hardaway's vote. Natasha overturns a table.
- **#0099 · Fri., May 20** — Ghost uncovers the bribe. Instead of exposing Esther, Marc walks Auburn Avenue at dawn holding deeds: DGH still owns Alexander's original 31 parcels, the heart of the project. *Cliffhanger*: "Congratulations, Esther. You just won a partnership with me."

Week of May 23 — May Sweeps

- **#0100 · Mon., May 23** — **THE 100TH EPISODE: "Auburn Crown."** Forced into a joint venture, Marc and Esther hold their first partnership meeting on the roof of Alexander's old Hotel Donohue. A summer storm hits, they fight, and they share their first kiss in the rain.
- **#0101 · Tue., May 24** — Esther runs, and Sebastian notices her smudged lipstick. At the hospital, Delphine throws the truth at Luke in a rage: Desmond is his father.
- **#0102 · Wed., May 25** — **MAY SWEEPS FINALE.** Luke confronts Vivienne, and she confirms it. In his hospital bed, Lucius hears every word. *Cliffhanger*: Lucius tears out his IV: "Get my lawyer. I'm changing everything."
- **#0103 · Thu., May 26** — Lucius signs a new directive confirming Esther as heir, removing Luke from Smiley Hotels, and stripping Desmond of the vice chairmanship. The House of Smiley implodes.
- **#0104 · Fri., May 27** — Desmond and Luke, now openly father and son, join Martin's alliance, and Knox goes on loan to them. *Cliffhanger*: Alone in the nursery, Esther whispers to the twins' photo: "I have to tell him."

Week of May 30

- **Mon., May 30** — *No new episode: Memorial Day.*
- **#0105 · Tue., May 31** — At **Victor's 69th birthday** dinner (held Memorial Day), he toasts "the next hundred years" and gives Marc control of the Auburn partnership. Esther drives to Belmont Crest to tell Marc the truth and finds Celeste kissing him on the Pavilion steps.

JUNE 2005

- **#0106 · Wed., Jun. 1** — Esther retreats and commits harder to Sebastian. Celeste tells Marc she's back for good, and Marc isn't sure he wants her to be.
- **#0107 · Thu., Jun. 2** — At **Natasha's 44th birthday**, Robert gives her a diamond. She gives him a file proving Camille has met the FBI twice. The Bullocks are a team again.
- **#0108 · Fri., Jun. 3** — Jeremy tells Elxa the truth about how she was appointed. *Cliffhanger*: Elxa types her resignation letter.

Week of June 6

- **#0109 · Mon., Jun. 6** — Elxa confronts Victor and Robert in the Manor library: "You took the one thing I earned." Joan overhears everything and turns on her husband.
- **#0110 · Tue., Jun. 7** — Mayor Whitaker refuses the resignation: "Your record is yours. Their sins are theirs." Elxa stays, but stops speaking to her father.
- **#0111 · Wed., Jun. 8** — After **Mallory's 20th birthday**, Quentin confesses that his father ordered him to spy on her. Mallory throws his gift into Lake Simone.
- **#0112 · Thu., Jun. 9** — Grace & Glory's lawyers prove Odessa Glow was stolen. The leak was a chemist Vivienne bribed, not Quentin, and Mallory realizes she punished the wrong man.
- **#0113 · Fri., Jun. 10** — Marc meets Tremaine Banks, a new 12-year-old in his mentoring program who argues like a Donohue and has Victor's eyes. *Cliffhanger*: Tremaine: "My mama says my daddy's somebody famous who parties too much."

Week of June 13

- **#0114 · Mon., Jun. 13** — Cornered by Doyle, Camille agrees to wear a wire inside DHG. On her first day she records Natasha arranging a "consulting fee" for a Monaco zoning board.
- **#0115 · Tue., Jun. 14** — Harlow takes Alvin on a lavish bender. Drunk, Alvin tells family stories, including Grace's "bad night" in 2000.
- **#0116 · Wed., Jun. 15** — Lyric spikes a fever, and Harmony and Amond spend the night together in the Grady ER under Loretta's watchful eye. The tenderness between them comes back.
- **#0117 · Thu., Jun. 16** — Consumed by guilt, Arianna writes a confession letter addressed to Harmony and locks it in her desk.

- **#0118 · Fri., Jun. 17** — On Martin's orders, Knox breaks into the DA's office looking for dirt on Marc and takes the letter. *Cliffhanger*: Martin reads the first line: "Harmony, I killed your brother."

Week of June 20

- **#0119 · Mon., Jun. 20** — At the **Juneteenth Lawn Party**, on Harmony's 23rd birthday, Amond gives her a locket with Lyric's picture and they kiss in front of everyone. Martin watches with Arianna's letter in his pocket.
- **#0120 · Tue., Jun. 21** — Martin blackmails Arianna: build a case against Blackwater's underboss, Amond, or Harmony gets the letter.
- **#0121 · Wed., Jun. 22** — Arianna tells Marc everything. He tells her to stall and sends Ghost after the letter. Harmony moves out of Amond's penthouse, into a house he secretly bought for her.
- **#0122 · Thu., Jun. 23** — Odessa returns the Savannah Letter to Simone in person at the Dowager House, on one condition: "We read it together."
- **#0123 · Fri., Jun. 24** — The queens read it aloud: Cornelius bluffed, Alexander stole the plans, and Simone copied them. *Cliffhanger*: Odessa: "So it was you all along." Simone: "It was always me."

Week of June 27

- **#0124 · Mon., Jun. 27** — The two queens make a secret pact that neither family learns the truth until both agree. Jasmine forms a gubernatorial exploratory committee.
- **#0125 · Tue., Jun. 28** — Peter confesses Harlow's blackmail to Jasmine. Her answer: "Fix it before my announcement."
- **#0126 · Wed., Jun. 29** — Peter anonymously tips the FBI about Julian Cross, and Harlow retaliates. Mallory's brakes fail on West Paces Ferry Road, and Quentin, who was following her to apologize, pulls her from the wreck.
- **#0127 · Thu., Jun. 30** — At Piedmont Hospital, Mallory and Quentin reconcile, and Quentin publicly defies his father. Peter realizes Harlow is willing to kill.

JULY 2005

- **#0128 · Fri., Jul. 1** — Peter goes to the one person Harlow seems to fear, without knowing why: Marc. *Cliffhanger*: Peter shows Marc a photo of "Julian Cross." Marc recognizes Harlow's eyes, and his glass hits the floor.

Week of July 4

- **Mon., Jul. 4** — *No new episode: Independence Day.*
- **#0129 · Tue., Jul. 5** — At the Fourth on the Lake fireworks, Marc tells The Seven: "Harlow's alive. The river gave him back." Amond realizes their first job was never finished.
- **#0130 · Wed., Jul. 6** — Harlow sends Grace a single white rose, the same kind from the 2000 party. She has a panic attack in the recording booth.
- **#0131 · Thu., Jul. 7** — Marc moves Grace into the Pavilion. Robert and Natasha put BSI details on every family member, and Victor demands to know what his grandson isn't saying.
- **#0132 · Fri., Jul. 8** — Jeremy matches a fingerprint on Julian Cross's club paperwork to Vaughn Harlow. *Cliffhanger:* "A dead man just bought a nightclub from Alvin Donohue."

Week of July 11

- **#0133 · Mon., Jul. 11** — Elxa brings Julian Cross in for questioning, but his lawyers get the fingerprint thrown out as contaminated. Alvin defends his partner, and Marc's jaw tightens.
- **#0134 · Tue., Jul. 12** — Still owed money by Alvin, and still bitter over the Summer of Silence, Silas Merriweather anonymously mails Harmony a package. Inside is Darnell Divine's wallet.
- **#0135 · Wed., Jul. 13** — The Divines realize Dee is dead. Calvin collapses at the wheel of his MARTA bus on Cascade Road.
- **#0136 · Thu., Jul. 14** — A shattered Harmony turns to Amond, who traces the wallet through Silas's courier and learns that Blackwater delivered a body to a Merriweather crematorium on January 1, 2002.
- **#0137 · Fri., Jul. 15** — Five years to the night since Grace's rescue, Amond confronts Marc at the River Gate boathouse: "Whose body, Marc?" *Cliffhanger:* Marc says, "I can't tell you," and Amond punches him into the Chattahoochee.

Week of July 18

- **#0138 · Mon., Jul. 18** — The Right Hand walks away from the Table, and for the first time The Seven are six. Marc sits alone between two empty chairs.
- **#0139 · Tue., Jul. 19** — The Divines hold a funeral without a body at Greater Crest Tabernacle. DA Arianna Cummings reads scripture, and Harmony thanks her.

- **#0140 · Wed., Jul. 20** — Investigating alone, Amond narrows the night of January 1, 2002 to three names in Marc's call log. One is Arianna.
- **#0141 · Thu., Jul. 21** — Watching Harmony grieve, Esther finally hands over her investigators' file with Northside Drive and Arianna's name. Harmony drives straight to the DA's office.
- **#0142 · Fri., Jul. 22** — Harmony asks Arianna point-blank. *Cliffhanger:* Arianna opens her mouth to confess, and Martin knocks on the door.

Week of July 25

- **#0143 · Mon., Jul. 25** — Pretending to help Harmony, Martin offers "proof" pointing to Sovereign as Dee's killer and turns her rage toward Blackwater. Harmony becomes a civilian informant for Elxa's task force.
- **#0144 · Tue., Jul. 26** — Elxa learns Amond has abruptly left BSI, and Jeremy flags him as a possible Blackwater lieutenant.
- **#0145 · Wed., Jul. 27** — Grace & Glory launches at Phipps Plaza, sells out in 11 minutes, and outsells Odessa Glow ten to one. Simone attends in a tiara.
- **#0146 · Thu., Jul. 28** — Camille's wire picks up Robert telling Natasha "Marc can never know about the mayor," and then: "Sovereign's people pay their retainers on time." Doyle realizes Robert Bullock is Sovereign's lawyer.
- **#0147 · Fri., Jul. 29** — Robert finds the wire in Camille's compact, and Camille flees. *Cliffhanger:* On the phone with Doyle, Camille says: "I'm pregnant. It's his."

AUGUST 2005

Week of August 1

- **#0148 · Mon., Aug. 1** — Theodore turns 71 in Monaco, and Martin calls to wish him happy birthday (we still hear only Martin's side): "Marc's head, legally. Understood." Martin brings together Desmond, Luke, Knox, and now Harlow.
- **#0149 · Tue., Aug. 2** — In a parking deck, Harlow tells Martin: "The night I took Grace Bullock, two boys came. The one who broke my face had the Donohue eyes." Martin begins to understand.
- **#0150 · Wed., Aug. 3** — Natasha visits Camille with a check, and Camille tears it up. Robert learns he'll be a father again at 46.

- **#0151 · Thu., Aug. 4** — Marc and Esther co-host the Auburn Crown groundbreaking. She insists she's still marrying Sebastian. He tells her he knows she's lying about something. He just doesn't know what.
- **#0152 · Fri., Aug. 5** — Drunk at Velvet, Amond is baited by Harlow: "How's your boss?" He realizes Harlow knows everything. *Cliffhanger:* Amond calls Marc for the first time in weeks: "He's back, and he knows my face."

Week of August 8

- **#0153 · Mon., Aug. 8** — Marc and Amond reach a fragile peace. Amond: "I'm back for Lyric, not for you." All seven chairs at the Table are filled again.
- **#0154 · Tue., Aug. 9** — The two queens slip their security and drive to Savannah in Simone's 1958 Cadillac with Winston at the wheel.
- **#0155 · Wed., Aug. 10** — In Savannah, Simone and Odessa visit the Jones Street house where it all began and bury the feud's origin under the courtyard magnolia. Back home, both families panic.
- **#0156 · Thu., Aug. 11** — Marc and Esther are sent to bring their grandmothers home. A blowout outside Metter strands them at a roadside motel with one room left.
- **#0157 · Fri., Aug. 12** — At the motel, Esther almost tells Marc about the twins. Instead, he tells her about the girl in the gold mask. *Cliffhanger:* Esther realizes he has been searching for her for four years.

Week of August 15

- **#0158 · Mon., Aug. 15** — Back in Atlanta, Esther asks Sebastian to postpone the wedding. Sebastian, secretly on Desmond's payroll, refuses and threatens to tell the press her "donor" story is a lie.
- **#0159 · Tue., Aug. 16** — Alvin wanders into Rochelle's College Park salon and comes face to face with Tremaine, a 12-year-old with his face. Rochelle: "Don't."
- **#0160 · Wed., Aug. 17** — Elxa learns she's pregnant and tells Jeremy with the positive test sealed in an evidence bag. They find joy in the middle of the storm.
- **#0161 · Thu., Aug. 18** — Their joy is shattered when Hughes leaks that Amond Baker, "a close associate of the Chief's brother," is a Blackwater target.
- **#0162 · Fri., Aug. 19** — Doyle asks Harmony to wear a wire on Amond. *Cliffhanger:* Harmony says yes.

Week of August 22

- **#0163 · Mon., Aug. 22** — Harmony wears the wire to dinner. Amond confesses that he loves her, and nothing else. She cries in the restroom.
- **#0164 · Tue., Aug. 23** — Drowning in guilt, Arianna tells Marc she's going to confess to Harmony. Marc begs her to wait until he can protect them all.
- **#0165 · Wed., Aug. 24** — Martin tests Harlow's theory by staging a threat at a Grace & Glory event. Marc and Amond respond like trained soldiers, and Martin watches their every move. Now he knows.
- **#0166 · Thu., Aug. 25** — With Sebastian's help, Knox takes a strand of hair from Victoria's brush in the Ravenhurst nursery, and Martin sends it for DNA testing against a glass Marc drank from.
- **#0167 · Fri., Aug. 26** — The news tracks a Category 5 hurricane named Katrina heading into the Gulf. Simone calls her family in New Orleans' Seventh Ward. *Cliffhanger*: Her great-nephew Andre tells her they're staying.

Week of August 29

- **#0168 · Mon., Aug. 29** — **THE STORM.** Katrina makes landfall on Elxa's 25th birthday, and nobody in the war room remembers. Marc launches BSI Crisis Response and, secretly, the Syndicate's Tithe toward the Gulf.
 - **#0169 · Tue., Aug. 30** — The levees fail. Marc flies into New Orleans with Roman's teams while Esther opens every Smilley hotel in the South to evacuees free of charge.
 - **#0170 · Wed., Aug. 31** — Marc's boat crews pull families off Seventh Ward rooftops. Esther arrives in Baton Rouge to personally run a joint Smilley–Donohue relief center.
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SEPTEMBER 2005

- **#0171 · Thu., Sep. 1** — Marc finds Andre Toussaint and his family alive on a roof. At 3 a.m. in the relief center, Esther falls asleep on Marc's shoulder. *Cliffhanger*: In Atlanta, a lab courier hands Martin a sealed envelope.
- **Fri., Sep. 2** — *No new episode: network news coverage of Hurricane Katrina.*

Week of September 5

- **Mon., Sep. 5** — *No new episode: Labor Day.*

- **#0172 · Tue., Sep. 6** — Back in Atlanta, Simone embraces Andre's family at the Dowager House. Every evacuee shelter in the city has been funded anonymously, and every donation arrived with an Onyx Coin. Sovereign becomes a national legend.
- **#0173 · Wed., Sep. 7** — Martin opens the envelope. The result: 99.99%. Marc-Anthony is the twins' father. He tells no one, then places a call overseas: "Come home. It's time."
- **#0174 · Thu., Sep. 8** — Changed by the storm, Esther hires BSI to secure her wedding and asks for Marc personally. He accepts, to be near her one last time.
- **#0175 · Fri., Sep. 9** — Robert and Natasha learn Camille will testify before a federal grand jury. *Cliffhanger:* At Ravenhurst, a man in a florist's apron walks the wedding grounds. It's Harlow.

Week of September 12

- **#0176 · Mon., Sep. 12** — **THE RETURN.** A black Maybach stops at the Crown Gate, and for the first time in two years the lights come on at Ashgrove. **Theodore Donohue** steps out, home from Monaco with his son Reginald. Victor: "Hello, brother."
- **#0177 · Tue., Sep. 13** — Theodore greets the family with smiles and gifts, and **Connie Donohue** makes her grand entrance. Privately, Theodore and Martin confirm their plan. Simone studies her eldest son: "You came home for a funeral. Whose?"
- **#0178 · Wed., Sep. 14** — At the rehearsal dinner, Esther asks Marc: "Give me one reason not to marry him." Marc gives her four years of reasons, and she walks away in tears. Theodore calls an emergency Crown Council for October.
- **#0179 · Thu., Sep. 15** — The audience learns that Connie is CrestWatch as she posts "WEDDING OF THE CENTURY, OR A FUNERAL?" Arianna mails her confession to Harmony by overnight courier.
- **#0180 · Fri., Sep. 16** — **SEASON FINALE.** Esther walks down the aisle at Ravenhurst. When the officiant asks for objections, three-year-old Victoria runs to Marc crying "I want my Marc!" Harmony reads Arianna's letter and turns to stare at Amond, and Martin whispers to Theodore, "I know who Sovereign is, and whose daughters those are." As Esther opens her mouth to answer, shots ring out from the tree line. Marc throws himself over Esther and the twins, and as blood spreads across her white gown, Esther screams: "**Marc, stay with me! They're yours! The girls are yours!**"
Fade to black.